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NATHAN FRANZ

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US Citizen

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Department of Economics, University of Texas at Austin, 2026
Committee: Sandra Black, Diane Coffey, Mike Geruso, Dean Spears (chair)
with certificate in Demography

M.A. Department of Economics, University of Texas at Austin 2020

B.S. Department of Mathematics and Department of Physics and Astronomy 2017
University of Wisconsin Oshkosh

RESEARCH

Working papers

Franz, N. Smooth operator: Too little variation in India's demographic estimates.

Franz, N. Cheaper and better? Explaining a newborn mortality advantage at public versus private hospitals in India.

Vyas, S., & Franz, N. Be careful what you ask for: Social desirability bias in self-reported data in India. Revision requested: *Journal of Development Economics*

Franz, N., Gupta, A., Spears, D., & Coffey, D. Uncertainty about maternal mortality in India: New, higher estimates from the National Family Health Survey-4. Revision requested: *Population Studies*.

Peer-reviewed journal articles

Coffey, D., Srivastav, N., Priya, A., Verma, A., Franz, N., Kumar, A., & Spears, D (2025). Excess neonatal mortality among private facility births in rural parts of high-mortality states of India: Demographic analysis of a national survey. *Social Science and Medicine*, *379*, 118158.

Smita, Franz, N., & Coffey, D. (2024). The association between cesarean birth and breastfeeding initiation in Odisha, India: A mother fixed effects analysis. *PLOS One*, *19*(2), e0287796.

Arenberg, S., Kuruc, K., Franz, N., Vyas, S., Lawson, N., LoPalo, M., Budolfson, M., Geruso, M., & Spears, D. (2022). Intergenerational transmission is not sufficient for positive longterm population growth. *Demography*, *59*(6), 2003-2012.

Franz, N., & Spears, D. (2020). Mere Addition is equivalent to avoiding the Sadistic Conclusion in all plausible variable-population social orderings. *Economics Letters*, *196*, 109547.

Other publications

Franz, N. (2025). When richer families pay more for worse care: Evidence from childbirth. *Ideas for India*, 21 November.

Coffey, D., Franz, N., Arenberg, S., Xu, M., & Vyas, S. (2022). Annual Health Survey (AHS), India, 2007–2012. Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research.

Spears, D., Franz, N., & Coffey, D. (2021). What can we learn about the Swachh Bharat Mission from the NFHS-5 fact sheets? *Ideas for India*, 2 February.

TEACHING

Spring 2025	Instructor of record for ECO 304K—Introduction to Microeconomics
Spring 2024	Teaching assistant for SOC 391L— Basic Demographic Methods and Materials (core course in the graduate Demography training sequence)
Fall 2022	Teaching assistant for SOC 391L— Basic Demographic Methods and Materials
Fall 2022	Teaching assistant, including giving a lecture, for ECO 333L— Development and Population
Spring 2022	Teaching assistant for ECO 441K—Introduction to Econometrics
Fall 2021	Teaching assistant for ECO 441K—Introduction to Econometrics
Fall 2020	Helped create new course materials and served as teaching assistant for SOC 591L— Basic Demographic Methods and Materials

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

2027, Jan	ASSA Annual Meeting
2026, May	Population Association of America Annual Conference (poster), Michigan Development Conference
2025, Nov	Northeast Universities Development Consortium, Hunter College, Clark University, North Texas Economics Conference

2025, Jun	American Society of Health Economists Conference
2025, May	Rosenkranz Global Health Symposium
2025, Apr	Population Association of America Annual Conference (poster & presentation) Texas Applied Microeconomics Student Workshop
2024, Nov	Southern Economics Association Annual Conference
2024, Apr	Population Association of America Annual Conference (poster), Texas Applied Microeconomics Student Workshop
2023, Apr	Population Association of America Annual Conference (poster), Texas Applied Microeconomics Student Workshop

External review

Referee for *Journal of Health Economics*, *Economics and Human Biology*, *Social Choice and Welfare*, *Scientific Reports*, *Food Policy*, and *The Indian Economic Journal*.

Awards and fellowships

2025, Nov	Best Graduate Student Paper, North Texas Economics Conference—$500
2025, Summer	Dissertation Writing Fellowship, UT Graduate School—$8,500

Professional experience

2026–	NICHD postdoc, Population Studies Center, University of Michigan
2023–2026	Research assistant for Dean Spears and Mike Geruso
2024–2026	Economics Department representative for College of Liberal Arts Graduate Student Advisory Council
2023–2026	Representative for Economics Graduate Student Association
2020–2021	Research assistant, Population Research Center, University of Texas at Austin.
2017–2019	Research analyst, then scientist. Dynetics, Inc. Huntsville, Alabama.